MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CLAMPS, ARTERY, DEBAKEY, SHALLOW "U" JAWS

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers artery clamps of the DeBakey design suitable for accomplishing hemostasis in delicate tissue.

1.2 Classification. Clamps shall be furnished in the following sizes and styles as indicated below:

Size	Overall Length (inches)	Style - Length of Jaws (centimeters)	
1	11	A	7.5
2	10-3/4	B	6.0
3	10-1/2	C	5.5
4	10	D	4.0
5	8-1/4	E	3.7

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

GG-I-526	- Instruments, Dental and Surgical, General Specifications
PPP-B-566	- Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-585	- Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	- Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	- Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-T-76	- Boxes, Set-up.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Hq., Defense Personnel Support Center, ATTN: Directorate of Medical Materiel, Code ATT, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MILITARY

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Methods Of.
MIL-L-10547 - Liners, Case, and Sheet Overwrap: Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

DRAWING

Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC) Drawing

No. 20901 CLAMPS, SATINSKY AND DEBAKEY, TANGENTIAL OCCLUSION

(Copies of specifications, standards and drawing required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

ASTM E 18 - Rockwell Hardness and Rockwell Superficial Hardness of Metallic Materials.

ASTM E 92 - Vickers Hardness of Metallic Materials, Test for.

ASTM E 140 - Standard Hardness Conversion Tables for Metals.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadephia, PA 19103.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 General requirements. The forceps shall be in accordance with the applicable requirements of GG-I-526 and as specified herein.

3.2 Material. The forceps shall be fabricated from class 4, type 410, 416 or 420 material.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3 Hardness. After proper stress relieving, the forceps shall have a Rockwell hardness of C36 to C41 for types 410 and 416 material; and C40 to C45 for type 420 material when tested as specified in 4.4.1. The requirements of GG-I-526 shall apply.

3.4 Style, design and dimensions. Shall be a tangential occlusion clamp of the DeBakey design. One jaw of the clamp shall be provided with two rows of well defined teeth, and the other jaw shall possess a single, central row, of well defined teeth. The depth of all teeth shall be consistent. The clamp shall provide a firm, non-slip, triangular grasp, for accomplishing hemostasis in delicate tissue, without causing trauma to the tissue. Clamps specified herein shall be of 5 sizes and 5 styles. Size 1 clamp shall be of style A (nominal jaw length of 7.5 cm). Size 2 clamp shall be of style B (nominal jaw length of 6.0 cm). Size 3 clamp shall be of style C (nominal jaw length of 5.5 cm). Size 4 clamp shall be of style D (nominal jaw length of 4.8 cm). Size 5 clamp shall be of style E (nominal jaw length of 3.7 cm). Clamps shall be in accordance with DPSC Drawing No. 20901 for appropriate size, style, stock number and item identification.

3.5 Locks. Shall be of box lock construction. Shanks shall be tested for lock stiffness in accordance with GG-I-526.

3.6 Finish. Finish shall be satin (non-reflective).

3.6.1 Passivation. The clamps shall be properly passivated.

3.7 Identification marking. In addition to GG-I-526 requirements, clamps of foreign manufacture shall also be marked "stainless".

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specifications where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection. Shall be in accordance with GG-I-526.

4.1.2 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T10:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the corrosion-resisting steel, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the National Stock Number (NSN), the item identification, the name of the material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as indicated in table I. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one clamp.

TABLE I. Sampling criteria for examination.

Type of defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	II	1.0
Minor	II	2.5

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as indicated in table II. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one clamp. Where feasible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

TABLE II. Sampling criteria for tests.

Component	Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL
Clamp	Hardness	3.3 & GG-I-526	4.4.1	S-2	1.5
	Dimensions	3.4	-----	S-2	1.5
	Copper sulfate test	GG-I-526	GG-I-526	S-2	1.0
	Boil test	GG-I-526	GG-I-526	S-2	1.0
	Lock stiffness test	3.5	GG-I-526	S-2	2.5

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T10:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.2.3 Raw materials. A sufficient quantity of each lot of metal used in the manufacture of the clamps shall be selected for chemical analysis.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Examination of clamps. The clamps shall be examined to determine compliance with all the requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted as indicated in tables I and III. Examination, however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in table III. Any clamps in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected, and if the number of defective clamps in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for the sample, the lot represented by that sample shall be rejected.

TABLE III. Classification of defects.

Categories	Defects
Critical	None defined.
Major	
101	Clamp not of the specified size and style for appropriate stock number and item identification.
102	Teeth of jaws not well defined and not of uniform depth.
103	Teeth of jaws do not mesh when clamp is closed.
104	Ratchet teeth not well defined.
105	Clamp not free from cracks, pits, burrs, sharp edges, rough areas, scale and corrosion.
106	Finish not as specified.
Minor	
201	Identification markings not present, not correct, not complete and not legible.

4.3.2 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the preservation-packaging and interior package marking shall be in accordance with the group A and B quality conformance inspection requirements of MIL-P-116. The inspection of the packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Hardness test. Hardness shall be determined in accordance with ASTM Std. Method E 18 or E 92. Conversion of Vickers hardness values to Rockwell values shall be in accordance with ASTM Std. Hardness Conversion Tables E 140.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-21T10:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation-Packaging. Preservation-packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Cleaning, drying and preservative. Each clamp shall be thoroughly cleaned and dried in accordance with the applicable method as outlined in MIL-P-116. Preservative shall not be applied.

5.1.1.2 Unit packaging. Each clamp shall be wrapped in neutral tissue or other suitable anticorrosive materials. Each clamp shall be further packaged in accordance with MIL-P-116, method 1C-1.

5.1.1.3 Intermediate packaging. Twelve (12) clamps shall be packaged in a box of appropriate size and design constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566, PPP-B-676 or PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.1.2 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. One hundred forty four (144) clamps shall be packed in a box designed for a type 2 load, and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2 or PPP-B-636, class weather resistant, grade V3c. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.1.1 Case liner. Each level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraphs of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Fiberboard box shall be waterproof in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. One hundred forty four (144) clamps shall be packed in a box designed for a type 2 load, and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 20260-21T10:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Unit, intermediate and exterior container. Each unit, intermediate and exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents shall specify the following:

(a) Number, title and date of this specification.
(b) Size and style required (see 1.2).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) Applicable National Stock Number.

6.2 This specification covers the following items appearing the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock Number	Item Identification	Specification Designation Size	Style
6515-00-690-3225	CLAMP, ARTERY, DeBakey, Shallow "U" Jaws, Partial Tangential Occlusion, 11 inch, 7.5 cm Jaw	1	A
6515-00-690-3227	CLAMP, ARTERY, DeBakey, Shallow "U" Jaws, Partial Tangential Occlusion, 10-3/4 inch, 6.0 cm Jaw	2	B
6515-00-690-3236	CLAMP, ARTERY, DeBakey, Shallow "U" Jaws, Partial Tangential Occlusion, 10-1/2 inch, 5.5 cm Jaw	3	C
6515-00-690-3237	CLAMP, ARTERY, DeBakey, Shallow "U" Jaws, Partial Tangential Occlusion, 10 inch, 4.8 cm Jaw	4	D
6515-00-690-3238	CLAMP, ARTERY, DeBakey, Shallow "U" Jaws, Partial Tangential Occlusion, 8-1/4 inch, 3.7 cm Jaw	5	E

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Project No. 6515-2020

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T10:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: The purpose of this form is to solicit beneficial comments which will help achieve procurement of suitable products at reasonable cost and minimum delay, or will otherwise enhance use of the document. DoD contractors, government activities, or manufacturers/vendors who are prospective suppliers of the product are invited to submit comments to the government. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements. Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity.

DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

MIL-C-37548 CLAMPS, ARTERY, DeBAKEY, SHALLOW "U" JAWS

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

TELEPHONE NO.

DATE

DD FORM 1 JAN 72 1426 REPLACES EDITION OF 1 JAN 66 WHICH MAY BE USED

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

FOLD

DEFENSE PERSONNEL SUPPORT CENTER
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, PA 19101

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

POSTAGE AND FEES PAID
DEFENSE SUPPLY AGENCY
DoD - 304

U.S. MAIL

HEADQUARTERS, DEFENSE PERSONNEL SUPPORT CENTER
ATTN: DIRECTORATE OF MEDICAL MATERIEL, CODE ATT
2800 SOUTH 20TH STREET
PHILADELPHIA, PA 19101

FOLD

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T10:58Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.